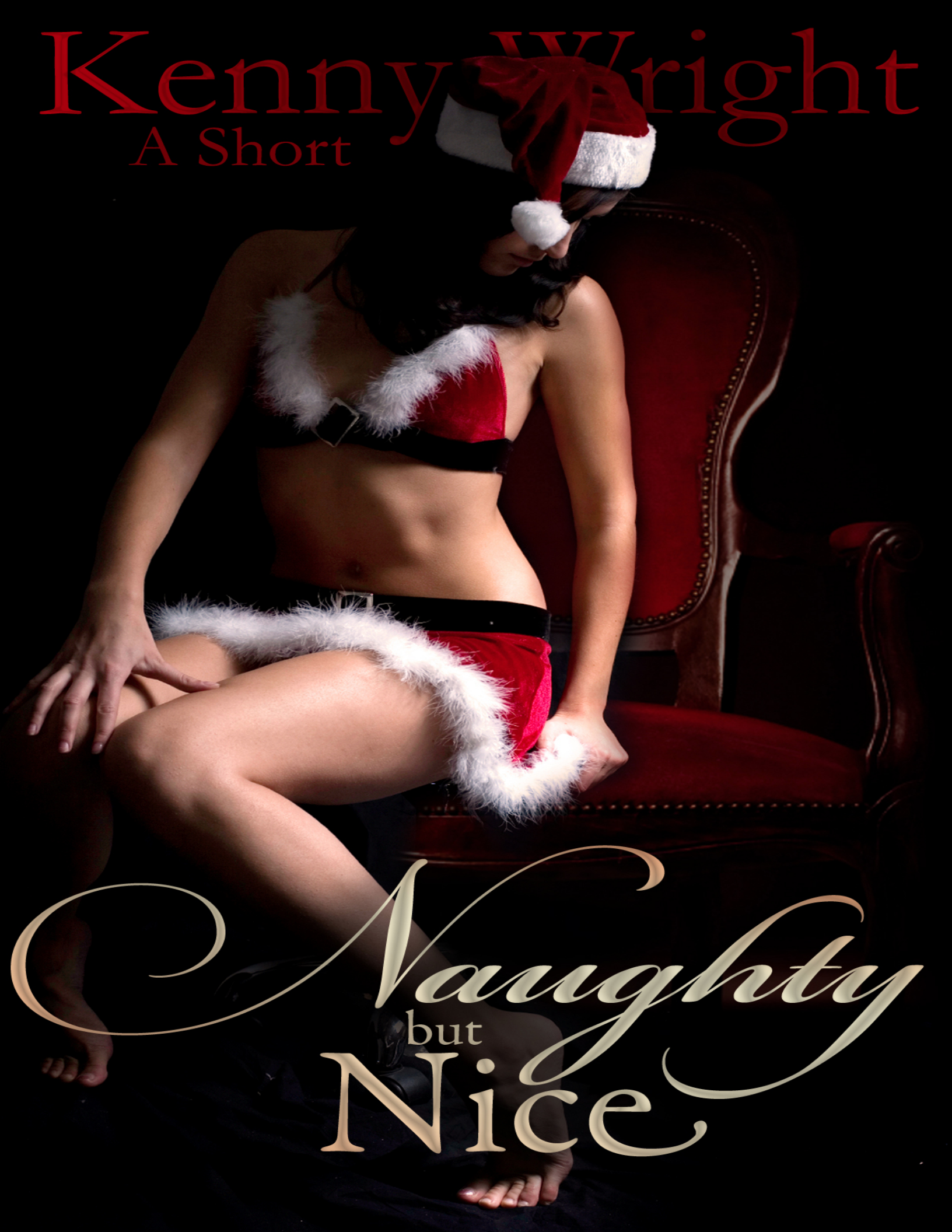


Kenny Wright

A Short



Naughty
but
Nice

Naughty But Nice

Kenny Wright



www.kennywriter.com

Naughty But Nice

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Edited by Summer Wright

Cover design by Kenny Wright

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First digital edition electronically published by Kenny Wright,
December 2012

Smashwords edition electronically published by Smashwords,
January 2013

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Preface

I love Christmas time. I won't go so far as to say that it's the most wonderful time of the year since I make it a habit not to compare the different times of year, but it's up there. It also tends to lend itself to erotica and erotic romance plots--at least to me. I've already written one ([*Observing Christmas Traditions*](#), you can find it on kennywriter.com), and have a longer piece in the works (look for Midnight Clear one of these Decembers). I've got two more brewing in my head, although they'll have to wait until 2013, most likely.

One of these days, I'll do a compilation of my Christmas short stories. For now, you've got Naughty But Nice. It's a shorty, but hopefully a goodie. Thank you for picking it up. I hope you have a merry Christmas and a happy New Year.

Enjoy!

Naughty
but
Nice

Kenny Wright

Taking photos of kids on Santa's lap wasn't exactly my dream job, but it involved a lens and it paid. The starving artist thing worked for the twenty-something version of me, but as I passed into my 30s, I talked myself into compromising a little. A guy needed to eat. And as far as compromises go, this one could have been worse.

"Ok, say, 'Jingle Bells!'"

The six-year-old twin boys were more interested in shoving each other and demanding toys from Larry, our shopping mall Santa, but that actually made for good photos. I snapped off a few shots of the tussle before refocusing them to capture that Christmas magic.

"Guys, want to guarantee you'll get everything you want for Christmas?"

The fighting died and all attention was on me. "How?" they asked in unison.

"You look right here." I pointed to the nose of the camera. "And say, 'I love you, mommy.'"

"I love you, mommy—" Flash. Got it.

Got a 'thank you' from their mother, too, frazzled as she was. I wondered if she'd be thanking me come tomorrow, when her kids were tearing open their presents and looking for their 'everything they wanted.'

Making moments like that was the rewarding part of the gig. My only real problem with it was the uniform. No, let's call it what it is: a costume. Larry got to hide behind a beard and a red felt fat suit. Me? My identity was as exposed as my pride. The ears and conical hat did nothing to disguise me, and let's not even get into the tight, red leggings.

But like I said, it could have been worse. I'd made it to Christmas Eve with some of my dignity intact. More than that. Watching a kid's face light up as he sat in Santa's lap could make my entire day.

"Alright, next family." That was Francis, head elf and director of this little slice of the North Pole. He was also a total prick. "Come right up. And no personal cameras!"

I peeked through the doors of the makeshift structure that passed for Santa's workshop. The line extended through the staged front yard and out into the shopping mall proper, which was obscured by the escalators. When I woke up this morning, I thought Christmas Eve would be light. Ha!

"Suzy, get up there." The bark belonged to the father of the next family unit entering "Santa's Workshop." He ushered his young daughter onto Santa's dais, her jaw set and nostrils flaring. This had trouble written all over it.

"But Dad, I don't want to."

"We've been standing in that damn line for the last hour. It's too late to back out now. We're getting this photo."

Oh boy, this wasn't good.

"Neat trick with that last family. Got any more?"

Suzy's mom, presumably, stepped up beside me. Her eyes were on the scene before Santa, and mine were all over her. This was another reason I loved my job: the moms. Dark haired and willowy with freckles dappling her pretty face, Suzy's mother wore dark, skinny jeans, brown boots, and a loose, lacy blouse over a darker tank top—a cool mom. There was also something naggingly familiar about her.

"I've got a few," I said. I couldn't puzzle out how I knew her.

“Suzy, get the hell up there.” To her mother, he said, “Meg, come on. Help me out here.”

Meg. Her name didn’t offer any clues.

“If she doesn’t want her picture taken, I’m not going to make her.”

Oh, the hate in that man’s eyes. Why did the pretty ones all come with the biggest assholes?

Leaving my station behind the camera, I ascended the dais and knelt down next to the child, ignoring the frown her father leveled at me.

“Suzy, Santa needs your help. Think you can help him?”

She hesitated, glancing past me at her mother before nodding. I met Larry’s eyes and saw him nod, too. We’d done this routine many times over the years. Larry and I were no strangers to the shopping mall Christmas experience and the challenges that came with it.

I pulled off my elf hat. “Santa needs a few more elves to help him deliver all his gifts tonight.”

Larry-as-Santa picked up. “I’m looking for good little girls and boys to volunteer. For tonight only. Would you like to be an honorary elf?”

I could see Suzy turning the proposition over in her head. She was a smart girl. The last child we’d worked this on had taken the bait right away. Suzy scrutinized it. “What do I need to do?”

“It’s really easy.” Her attention swung back to me. “Tonight, when you go home, you need to make sure Santa has a nice big plate of cookies and a glass of milk out by the tree. Can you do that?”

“Yes!”

I slipped my green elf hat on her head. “Then you are now officially one of Santa’s Little Helpers.”

Larry took it home. “Alright, Suzy. Let’s get a photo of us so I can remember my newest elf.”

Suzy hopped onto Santa’s lap without pause and I retreated behind my camera. The elf hat was big on Suzy, sitting askance atop her dark curls. She pushed it off her brow as she regarded Santa with a smile. I couldn’t have staged a better shot. If I were to put anything from his job in my portfolio, this would have been the one.

“I’m not paying for the hat.” It was the only thing Suzy’s father said to me before storming off to the photo kiosk.

“I’m impressed.” Earning the praise of Suzy’s mother was almost as rewarding as putting a smile on her girl’s face. “You have kids?”

“No, ma’am. Us elves are forbidden.”

“That’s a shame. I’m sure that rule makes a lot of female elves sad.”

Was she really flirting with me? I glanced at Suzy’s father, waiting impatiently in line to order his over-priced prints. I didn’t think he’d take too kindly if I got friendly with his wife. Still, I was a sucker for dark hair and blue eyes.

“I’d bend the rules if we had any female elves.” Like you, for example. “But it seems that only guys are willing to parade around a department store in tights and shoes that curl at the toes for ten bucks an hour.”

Meg covered her mouth as she laughed, giving me a once over. I kept in good shape, and as goofy as the costume was, the tunic complemented my broad chest, while the tight sleeves could make anyone’s arms look good. Still, it *was* an elf costume.

“I think it’s pretty cute, actually. And besides, we’re all entitled to some silly decisions. For example, bringing your ex along for some quality Christmas time.” She gestured at Suzy’s father. “Not such a great idea, in hindsight.”

So you’re single? I almost asked. Suzy came over before I could.

“Thanks, Mr. Elf.”

“Call me Dan. Us elves should be on a first name basis.” I could feel both smiles on me, warm as the morning sun.

“Can my mom be an elf, too?”

As innocent as her question was, my mind went to a dirty place. I looked into Meg’s deep blue eyes. “I don’t know. She’d have to wear one of our outfits.”

Meg’s smile widened. I swear I’d seen that smile somewhere. It was a hard one to forget.

Suzy answered for her. “Mommy wouldn’t mind doing that. Would you, mommy?”

“I’d love to.” She ruffled Suzy’s hair, beneath her hat. “Come on kiddo, let’s get going. Merry Christmas, Dan the Elf. And thanks again.”

Meg took Suzy by the hand. I watched them go. God bless the skinny jean trend, and the women who could pull it off.

“Ahem.” King Francis came calling.

“Right. Photos. Say, ‘Jingle Bells!’”

That encounter had me smiling through most of the day. I always liked the idea of kids—just not with the woman I’d suffered five years

of marriage with. Now if I'd married a woman like Meg, things might have turned out differently.

Not that I'd ever see her again. "Such is the life in Santa's service," I joked with Larry. Our day had wound down, and at last we got the shopping lull I'd been expecting all day.

"She was into you, man. You should have hit that."

"I'm sure Francis would have understood. 'Excuse me, Master Elf, while I take this young woman back into the workshop and have my way with her.'"

"Hey, I could have authorized it. I'm Santa, after all. Francis works for me."

We cracked up. I always enjoyed working with Larry. "You know, you're probably the filthiest St. Nick I've ever met."

"Speaking of, can I change your mind on the strip club tonight? The dancers at Orchid Lounge are even dressing up as sexy elves. I plan on wearing the Santa suit. Keep yours on and maybe you can get your fantasy after all."

"I never should have told you about that." I'd had this recurring dream about hooking up with a hot, female elf on Santa's chair. "I'm going to pass. But I can lock up here. You take off."

"Oh, come on, Dan. Live a little. It's Christmas Eve."

"Spending my paycheck on strippers is living a little too much for me. And with this job ending, I'm going to need to watch my money."

"Suit yourself. Maybe Santa will bring a gift to such a *nice guy*."

"I didn't think Santa was allowed to be sarcastic."

"I'm off the clock, elf, and the only thing jolly about this guy is little St. Nick." His face softened and he opened his arms wide. "It's

been fun working with you, Dan. We're going to hang out this year. For real this time."

We'd made that promise for the last three Christmases, but for some reason, we never did.

"You're a good photographer, boy scout attitude or not. Good luck out there."

"You too, man. Merry Christmas."

"Last chance to come out. I'll buy the first dance."

"I'm good. Take care, Larry."

I watched him go, wondering if this was the year that we'd move beyond convenient acquaintances. I got the impression that he was very different than me, but it could still work. I wondered if I'd even recognize him, dressed down like a civilian, going about his regular life.

Regular life. The prospect loomed over my future. I always got a little melancholy when the holiday season ended. The radio went back to playing pop music. Trees draped in lights just looked like trees again. All the garland came down. Everything just became... normal.

Santa's Workshop had been constructed in the center of this upscale shopping mall, the North Pole transported. Fluffy cotton snow covered the eaves, frost ringed the windows, and lights were strung everywhere. The queue wound through the front yard, marked by candy cane stanchions and a trail of trash. Many stores in the mall had extended their hours to catch the procrastinating shoppers, but it was just eight o'clock and only a few harried stragglers remained.

I fastened the red velvet rope across the entrance of the queue, officially closing us for the season, picked up a few pieces of trash, and went back into the little house. I'd spent more time in here than I had at my own place. Work benches lined the sides of the front room, littered with wooden toys and pamphlets outlining the photo packages to purchase. At the far end of the faux house was Santa's chair, a red-cushioned throne, trimmed in gold (gold paint, anyway). The bright floods were off, but I could still imagine the chair in all its holiday glory.

And when I did, my sexy elf fantasy filled in the rest. This time, though, the elf resembled Meg, dressed in a green satin mini, lined in white fur. My mind put her in a dress short enough to reveal the red garters where they clipped into her white stockings, and a pair of impractically tall heels.

I sank into the plush cushions of Santa's chair and fought back the urge to touch my stiffening cock. The chair was just as heavenly as it had been in my dreams. The cushions cradled me. The back rose up around my shoulders, plush yet firm. Even the slight elevation of the dais felt heavenly.

I closed my eyes for just a moment as the fantasy washed over me. I touched Meg's face as she settled into my lap. Her hand brushed against my cock, feeling it swell in the tightness of my leggings. She leaned in to kiss me, and--

"Um, am I interrupting something?"

My heart nearly tore from my chest at the woman's voice. My fantasy fled in a billow of heat. "No. Just getting off my feet."

"Looked like you were getting off of something." The workshop didn't have a door, but only one of the curtains was tied back, leaving

the interior dim. Still, when she stepped through, I knew exactly who it was. Meg. Maybe I was still fantasizing, after all.

“Lack of female elves really is a problem, isn’t it?”

“Can I help you?” What else could I say?

“Always looking to help. You know, the boss is away now—out delivering gifts to good boys and girls.”

Or having strippers crawl over him. That image didn’t help matters.

In the dim light, her pale skin glowed and her eyes shined. Her little ears peeked out through her dark hair. And on her head she wore a green, pointed hat, topped with a white pom-pom. “Nice hat.”

“An elf can’t be without her hat, right?”

“That’s true.” I may have been paid to play an elf, but she looked more the part. “But an elf is more than her headwear.”

“Oh, like this?” She unbelted her coat and slipped it off. “It’s a little home-brew, but I think it should pass inspection.”

While not as over-the-top as my fantasy had been, it was still an elf costume, and Meg still looked sexy in it. She wore a shimmering green blouse, untucked and belted over a short red skirt. Her legs looked good, shaped by the ankle boots and encased in candy cane knee socks.

“I’d say that works.” Something was missing though. I stood, pulling off my pointed ears. “Here, try these on. It’ll complete the look.”

Meg stepped onto the stage. In her heels, she was nearly my height. “I’m not sure how to put them on.”

“Let me.”

I pushed the silky fall of her dark hair back over each ear and fastened the latex appendages. The company supplied us with cheaper costume elf ears, but long ago I'd decided that if I was going to play the part of an elf, it was going to be authentic. The pointed ears looked good on me; they looked natural on Meg.

"You're like Liv Tyler."

"I don't think Arwen had freckles. And she had grey eyes. Mine are blue."

A Tolkien fan. God, how hot was that?! "She also wasn't in Santa's service."

She grew modest under my inspection, batting her lashes and looking around the space. Who would have thought that a pair of ears could transform her beauty into something supernatural?

"So actually, I'm here because I do need your help."

"Yeah?" My heart thumped with all the naughty possibilities.

"Yeah. I left a shopping bag earlier today. From the Disney Store. They told me you had it in the back. I hope it's here or Santa's not going to be so popular tomorrow morning."

"Oh, right. Hold on." So that was disappointing, but made sense. I hopped off the chair and turned my back to her, hoping she didn't see my erection beneath my tunic. "We keep the lost and found items back here."

I pulled away the curtain that served as the photo's backdrop. We'd used the space to stash other things—candy canes, photo frames, extra elf hats—but most of that was gone now. The Disney bag was easy to spot.

Pulling it out, I turned right into her. I caught myself on her shoulders, dropping the bag. I think the contents may have spilled

out. For a moment, my world was filled with nothing but her blue irises, flecked with silver and drawn out more by the metallic tint of her eye shadow.

Then we were kissing. Just like that.

She tasted like autumn, crisp and cozy. A kiss to curl into and savor. When she pressed her tongue against my lips and I let her in, things took a harder edge, and when she pulled away, all I wanted was more.

“That was the other reason I came back. I’ve wanted to do that... for a long time.” She sounded as breathless as I felt.

“For a long time? Like how long.”

Meg flushed, but didn’t look away. “I’ve had a secret crush on you for the past three years.”

Erm. First I thought I might be dreaming. Now I was pretty sure I was. “I don’t understand—”

She stepped back and half-sat on the arm of Santa’s chair. “You shot a friend’s wedding back then. I was one of the bridesmaids. We all thought you were cute.”

I thought back on the weddings I’d shot in the past. Like this gig as Santa’s elf, the wedding jobs had started as a way to bolster my teaching job, and turned into something semi-permanent.

“When was the wedding?”

“October. At a country club. We wore red satin dresses and... and you took a picture of me crying during the ceremony.”

Then it all came back. “The Walters wedding, right?”

“Walshes. Close enough. You remember now?”

How could I have forgotten. Meg had captivated me that day. I had to stop myself from taking more photos of her than the bride as

they assembled before their dearly beloved. At first, I thought she'd just been moved by the moment. Later, when I looked back through the photos, I saw it for what it was: profound sadness. That shot *had* gone into my portfolio.

"Your hair was shorter, right?"

"Yeah. I cut it before Suzy was born."

"You were so sad. Are you happier now?"

When she looked at me, I shivered. "Yeah. I'm in a better place. It was at that wedding that I started to reevaluate my life. It was the beginning of the end for me and my ex. I should have been happy for my best friend, but all I could think about was how terrible married life could be. And that's fucked up."

"I know what you mean. Mine wasn't as abrasive as your ex seems to be, but she was full of crazy."

"I thought elves were forbidden."

I laughed. "I wish someone had told me. It would have saved me five years of my life." I stared at her, suddenly hating the idea that we were dredging up the past. "How are you even here? What about Suzy?"

"My parents are staying the night. This will be her first Christmas without her father, so I called in the reinforcements." She touched her hat. "But I don't think it was necessary. She's been talking non-stop about her new elf status since we got home. You made her Christmas."

"Nothing that anyone in Santa's service wouldn't do."

She rolled her eyes. "Whatever. Most guys don't have the patience or the creativity to do that. My wonderful ex-husband, for example."

"I'm not your ex."

She laughed and reached out for me. “No, you’re not.”

I took her hand and let her pull me against her. We kissed again. I was still pretty sure this was a dream, but for now, it didn’t really matter.

“So you came all the way back here to kiss me?”

“Well, mainly to get that present, but I told myself that if you were still here, I wasn’t going to pass up the opportunity again.”

“I’m glad you didn’t.”

“Otherwise you’d have to take care of yourself alone.”

Right. She’d seen that. The fire was back on my face. Meg rescued me.

“No need to get all embarrassed. I’ve been divorced for a year. I know a thing or two about those things.”

“That’s so hot.” My hushed comment just slipped out.

“Isn’t it?” She nuzzled against me. “How ‘bout we go back to Santa’s chair and do it the right way.”

“You’re a naughty one.”

“You’re not going to tell Santa, are you?”

I laughed. The Santa I knew would totally dig the idea of me fooling around with this hot mom in his seat. “Hm, I don’t know. He is my boss, after all.”

“While the boss is away, the elves will play...”

She pushed me into the chair and crawled into my lap. We kissed for a long time, the chair cradling me as I cradled Meg. At first, I kept my hands to proper places: her long back, her narrow waist, the silky warmth at the nape of her neck.

As the kissing grew heated, so did our touches. I ran my hand along her thigh, caressing the bare skin between knee-high sock and

skirt. After a few minutes of that, though, I knew I wanted more. Meg was right there with me. So I pushed my hand higher, up under the hem of her red skirt.

She shifted in my lap. For a moment, I took that to be her signal that I'd gone too far. Then I realized she was just lining her pussy against the bulge in my leggings. My hands climbed higher, discovering a thong plunging between her round buttocks.

I pulled her against me as we began to hump in the chair. She leaned out of the kiss and unbuttoned her blouse. I worked the clasp of her belt. Meg's freckles swept across her chest and onto the upper slopes of her small breasts, encased in a red satin bra. The rest of her was pale and unblemished, like a canvas of parchment just out of the painter's reach.

This was crazy. I could hear the foot traffic around us, of people pushing strollers and chattering about sales and parking validation. Not even twenty feet around us, the world went about its mundane business. Yet there we were, hidden in plain sight.

Meg unfastened her bra, drawing my attention back to her. Her nipples stood hard and proud, casting short shadows on her dappled flesh.

I teased her with the tips of my thumbs, drawing a moan before taking them into my mouth. When I swirled my tongue across the textured areola, Meg clutched my head against her breasts. Her hips started humping me once again, but I needed more.

I glanced over her shoulder, where the entrance to the workshop was covered by half a drape. All that kept us from discovery was a velvet rope and half a curtain. A spike of adrenaline raced through me.

“Take off your skirt.”

Meg had to slide off me to do so, leaving her in nothing but her striped knee-socks, ankle boots, and a red thong that matched her discarded bra. Pulling my tunic off, Meg sized up my spandex covered form.

“You have a nice body for an elf,” Meg said. She wiggled into the chair beside me and I shifted to accommodate her. She squeezed my biceps through my tight, red shirt. “I thought elves were supposed to be skinny.”

I peeled the shirt over my head, feeling Meg’s approval crawl over the ripple of my abs and broad chest. “This elf works out.”

“Mm, I can see that.”

I ran my hand along the pale curve of her hip and waist. “You, on the other hand, are like the perfect elf.”

“Yeah? Would the perfect elf do this?” She pushed her hand inside my pants and squeezed my cock. “Or this?”

Yanking my green elf tights down, she leaned forward and took me into her mouth. I arched into the chair as wet pleasure washed over me. She swallowed half my length before slowly drawing up and off. “Something else that’s not small, I see.”

“Well, I have a confession. I’m not really an elf.”

“So that means we’re not breaking any rules.” With that, she returned to my cock. This time, she swallowed all seven inches to the root.

I threaded my fingers through her soft hair, riding the bob of her head rather than guiding it. Somehow, her protruding elf ears made this experience even hotter.

My other hand was restless. I reached around and dipped it between her thighs, rubbing it across the damp satin of her thong.

A moan welled up in her throat, rippling around my shaft when I pressed two fingers against her clit. I eased under the thin panties and touched her directly.

She pulled off to gasp and sigh. “Yes, right there.” She rocked her sex against my hand. Her nether lips were like wet silk, although I could feel cropped curls just above the spot where my thumb worked her button.

I teased her with my fingers, playing at the entrance of her sex without penetrating. I only plunged them in when she went back to her blow job. Then I matched her strokes with my hand.

Meg bounced her head fast; I fingered her in sync. When she slowed down to give me those agonizing swirls of her tongue, I curled my fingers against her g-spot and thumbed her clit.

She lost it before I did, but I couldn’t hold back as her moans quaked about my shaft. I exploded down her throat and she swallowed it all.

Meg snuggled against me, her lips on the crook of my neck. “That was for the ears.”

I touched her elf ears as I cradled her face and kissed her deep. I could taste traces of myself—well worth it to feel the slide of her tongue on mine.

“This is thanks for everything else.” She slipped her thong down her thighs and straddled my lap. This time, nothing separated my cock from her pussy, and as she rubbed the slippery skin along my deflated member, new life was borne. She kept a dart of dark hair above her clit, but was otherwise bare.

Outside, I heard someone comment on how cute Santa's Workshop was. "Too bad they can't keep it up all year round," the woman said.

"I'm going to miss the holidays," another agreed.

Meg reached between us and thrummed herself with my semi-erect cock. "I'm going to miss the holidays, too," she whispered.

Half a minute of that and I was stiff enough to pass into her wet opening. I grew with each pass, slow and short at first, then ever faster.

"This is what I was thinking about."

Meg looked at me, brow furrowed.

"When you caught me earlier. I was fantasizing about doing this, right here in this chair." My heart jumped. "In this chair with you."

"You were playing with yourself, thinking of me?"

I wasn't sure who was more surprised, me for my confession or her for hearing it.

"I've never been someone else's fantasy."

Looking up into her face with her galaxy of freckles, I didn't think that was true. "Well, you were mine."

"How do I live up?"

"You surpassed it when you kissed me. I still can't believe this is happening."

We listened to someone ask for parking validation outside.

"Kinky, huh?" she asked.

"Fucking in the middle of the mall? 'Kinky' doesn't come close to describing it."

"Then let's stop trying. Just do me." She squeezed my cock with her pussy. I squeezed her ass in return.

Once I was hard, we stopped holding back. She dug her knees in and started bouncing on my lap, gripping my shoulders for leverage. When that wasn't enough, she reached for the back of the chair, stretching her body before me. Her breasts bounced, level with my face. I couldn't help but suck them in. She rocked harder, stroking my member with her liquid caress.

She curled her fingers in my hair, dislodging my hat as she clutched me tight. Pressed between her breasts, I could hear her moans well up in her chest before she caught them in her throat. I could hear her squelched gasps and the steady pound of blood in her veins.

She folded over me like a bow being drawn taut. Her breathing came ragged. A moan escaped, wavering clear and terrifying in the half-enclosed space. Had that drawn glances? Was someone coming over to investigate?

The danger unloosed the arrow. I drew her into my lap, held her tight, and came. Meg crashed through her climax as quietly as one could crash through anything. She bit her lip and flared her nostrils, but more was ready to be unleashed. In a last desperate move to keep her quiet, I kissed her.

That kiss, more than anything, is what I'll remember about the night for years to come. It was Hollywood. Explosions could have been going off around us and yet all that mattered was how perfectly our mouths fit together.

When we came down, mall security hadn't shown up and Meg was still in my lap, panting yet real.

"So this isn't some kind of fantasy?"

She offered a smile that I was already falling in love with. “Well, I wouldn’t say that. But if you’re asking if that really happened, then yes.”

I held her as our sweat cooled on our skin and the echo of footsteps and conversation filtered in. I glanced at the entrance, but all I could see was fake snow and a candy cane path. The real world was trying to get in, but for now, the magic held.

I reached for Santa’s red velvet sack, empty now, and pulled it over us to stay warm. Meg snuggled close and for the longest time, we just enjoyed the feel of our skin on skin. We kissed. We caressed. I had no idea what time it was, but the foot traffic outside had begun to die down.

Finally, I said the thing I’d been trying to put off. “You should probably get home before Suzy--and your parents--begin to wonder what happened.”

“Trying to get rid of me?”

“Not at all. I’d love for you to come back to my place so I could unwrap you all over again.”

She didn’t acknowledge my unspoken *but*. “I like that thought.” The sad bridesmaid made a reappearance, but only for a moment. “Maybe not tonight, but... I don’t want this to be a one time thing.”

“I don’t either.”

She let go of a breath, relief sweeping across her face. She kissed me again before standing. I watched her dress, pulling on the thong and fastening her matching bra. Now there was a photo I’d like for my portfolio.

At last, I joined her, donning my tunic and tights.

We emerged from the workshop, shielding our eyes against the unnatural light of the mall. A few late shoppers gave us looks, but no one questioned what we'd been doing. We looked like a couple of people ending a long day at work.

"It feels wrong to be so bright in here," Meg said.

It feels wrong to be out here at all. I wanted to crawl back into that temporary world that only existed right before Christmas, but it was already slipping away. Instead, I just nodded.

"What's wrong?"

"It's silly. I'm just being sentimental. I get like this around the holidays." I stopped, but she kept looking at me. "My life as an elf is always bittersweet. Tomorrow, I'll wake up and be Dan Baker again—a guy who somehow makes a living as a photographer. It's not a bad life. But I'm—"

"Alone."

"Yeah, I guess that's it." I forced a chuckle. "I didn't even decorate my place this year."

Her pert, upturned nose crinkled in consideration.

"What?" I asked.

"Just trying to work through something."

"You going to share? Or is this a private moment?"

Meg laughed. "I was just wondering how Suzy would react if we had an elf over tomorrow for dinner."

About the Author

Kenny Wright is just a guy who writes what he likes to read: steamy, explicit erotica that's just crazy enough to be true. Narrative, characterization, build-up, and tension are what make something sexy—the way the body parts fit together are just nice-to-haves (albeit *really* nice-to-haves). That's what he strives to write in every story, short and long. Oh, and being a guy, he believes in a world where men read and appreciate erotica, and hopes to contribute it word by word.

Husband to his beautiful wife, father to his rambunctious daughter, and food slave to his needy cat, he squeezes writing in when he probably should be sleeping. Kenny welcomes comments from readers. He can be reached at kennywright.writer@gmail.com, or if you're more the voyeur, find him on Twitter at @kennywriter or at www.kennywriter.com.

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